

crime AARUSHI MURDER CASE



AN UNFINISHED LIFE

Aarushi Talwar would have been a bright 14-year-old, balancing school, tuitions, dance classes and a wide group of friends. But now she is just a shorthand for one of the most lurid crimes in recent history, which even two months into its high profile existence doesn't look like being solved.

■ By Kaveree Bamzai and Mihir Srivastava

We regret day and night. But overcoming those regrets is not that easy." These were the last words written on Aarushi Talwar's whiteboard. As the remaining three members of her gang Awesome Foursome read it, seated on the wrought iron bed in her blood splattered room, the afternoon after her murder, a chill went down their spine. Recalls her friend, the extraordinarily self-possessed Fiza Jha, her classmate at Delhi Public School (DPS), Noida, and at Ashley Lobo's jazz dance classes, "She wasn't a very philosophical girl. I found it odd." As was what Aarushi told her classmates while playing Truth or Dare the day she died: "I will always be there for all of you, whether I am physically present or not."

In almost two months of the most riveting murder mystery to grip India's middle-class, these are not the only things that were odd. Here